

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q J 9 6

♥ 4

♦ K Q J 7

♣ A K Q

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A 8 4

♥ A 8 7 3

♦ T 9 5

♣ 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

[show S] [BID 2NT] [BID 4!S] [BID 5!H] [BID Pass] [show NS] 2NT shows a balanced hand with 8+ points, and when SOUTH then supports ♠s NORTH makes a slam try.

NORTH bids RKC Blackwood 4NT. SOUTH shows two Keycards (two Aces) and NORTH bids 6♠.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-
♥	-
♦	-
♣	-

♠ K J

♥ Q J 8 5

♦ Q T 9 7

♣ Q 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠	-
♥	-
♦	-
♣	-

♠ A Q 7

♥ K T 7 4 2

♦ K J 3

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♥
All Pass			
5 ♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 5!H] [show NS] NORTH has a decent Limit Raise, and SOUTH tries RKC Blackwood.

NORTH replies to the 4NT bid with 5 ♦, zero or three Keycards. So which is it, zero or three?

Pretty simple - since SOUTH holds three Keycards himself NORTH can hardly have three also since there are only five total. She must have zero and SOUTH signs off at 5 ♥.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-
♥	-
♦	-
♣	-

♠ K T 7 4
 ♥ K Q J 8 4
 ♦ A 6
 ♣ A 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 8 6 3 2
 ♥ 5
 ♦ K Q 7
 ♣ K Q 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

[show S] [BID 1!S] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!S] [show NS]
 NORTH jumps to 4 ♠, confident that SOUTH could make 10 tricks even if he just has 6 points.

SOUTH knows he can make more and bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH's 5 ♦ response shows zero or three Keycards. So which is it? Zero or three?

NORTH bid much too strongly to have no Aces. SOUTH bids a confident 6 ♠, knowing NORTH has either three Aces or two Aces plus the ♠K.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 7 5

♥ Q T 8 3

♦ A 8 5 4

♣ 9 2

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ 6

♥ A K 9 7 5 4

♦ 6

♣ K Q J T 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!H] [show NS] With eleven cards in the "round" suits SOUTH has a lot of playing strength. So when NORTH bids a Limit Raise in ♥s SOUTH wants to know about Aces.

RKCBlackwood tells him that NORTH has two Aces plus the trump Queen, so SOUTH can see that 6♥ is practically a certainty.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K 9 8 4 2

♥ K Q T 6

♦ 8 4

♣ A

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 7 3

♥ A J 5

♦ T 6 3 2

♣ K 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

[show S] [BID 3!S] [BID 4!H] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH has interest in slam after she hears SOUTH's Limit Raise. BUT, she should not use Blackwood holding two quick losers in the ♦ suit.

Instead she makes a Control showing bid of 4♣. (Not Gerber since it didn't follow a NT bid.)

SOUTH cooperates by making a Control bid of 4♥.

NORTH stops at 4♠ because neither partner controls ♦s.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -
♥ -
♦ -
♣ -

♠ A J 7
♥ J 6
♦ Q J T 8 7
♣ A 6 4



♠ -
♥ -
♦ -
♣ -

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ A K 9 6 3
♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♠	Pass	6 ♦
All Pass			
6 ♦ by North			

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!D] [show NS] SOUTH decides it is unlikely that NORTH is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces NORTH does have. He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, NORTH bids as if ♦s, the last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. NORTH has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5 ♠.

SOUTH bids 6 ♦. If NORTH had just one Key-card, SOUTH would bid 5 ♦ over the 5 ♣ reply.

Board 7
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q 7

♥ J 6

♦ A 6 4

♣ Q J T 8 7

♠ 6

♥ K Q 8 7 2

♦ K Q

♣ A K 9 6 3

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID Pass] [show NS] This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, SOUTH has no problem as long as NORTH holds at least one Key-card. When NORTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), SOUTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣		
All Pass			
5♣ by North			

Board 8

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K 6

♣ A K 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

[show S] [BID 1NT] [BID 4!S] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

Board 9

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-
♥	-
♦	-
♣	-

♠ A J T 5
 ♥ A K
 ♦ K 5
 ♣ A K Q J 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 8 7 4 3
 ♥ Q 7 5
 ♦ -
 ♣ 9 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			
7♠ by South			

[show S] [BID 2!S] [BID 6!D] [BID Pass] [show NS] SOUTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

NORTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

SOUTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

NORTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Board 10

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 6

♥ A Q 8 7 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 8 7

♠ K Q 3

♥ K T 9 3

♦ A 6

♣ K Q 9 6

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

[show S] [BID 1NT] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!H] [show NS] NORTH jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

SOUTH has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for SOUTH to bid the slam.

Board 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ A Q 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ A 5

♣ K J 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K T 7 5 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 8 6

♣ A Q 4

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♣	Pass	7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

[show S] [BID 2!S] [BID 4NT] [BID 5!H] [BID 7NT] [show NS] When NORTH agrees to ♠s, SOUTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells SOUTH that they have all five Key Cards since NORTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

SOUTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and NORTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

SOUTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Board 12

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-
♥	-
♦	-
♣	-

♠ A K 7 5 3

♥ 8

♦ K Q 7 2

♣ K Q 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠	-
♥	-
♦	-
♣	-

♠ Q 8 6

♥ Q J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ A J 6 5

[show S] [BID 1NT] [BID 4!S] [BID 5!S] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. SOUTH's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when NORTH claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

Board 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 9 3
♥ A T 6
♦ A 9 8 6 2
♣ K 9



♠ A Q J 6 5 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ Q
♣ A 8 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

[show S] [BID 3!S] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!S] [show NS]

When SOUTH makes a slam try with a jump to 3♠, the best approach for NORTH is to agree on the trump suit immediately but indicate a minimum hand by bidding 4♠.

SOUTH's next move is logical; RKCB 4NT.

NORTH shows zero or three Key Cards, and since it could not possibly be zero, SOUTH knows they are the ♠K and both red Aces. Even possessing all the Key Cards SOUTH knows there aren't enough points for a Grand slam.

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K
 ♥ Q J 3
 ♦ A K Q 5
 ♣ A 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 5
 ♥ A K 9 8 7 4 2
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ 8 7

West	North	East	South
			3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by North			

[show S] [BID 3!H] [BID 5!H] [BID Pass] [show NS] It is usually not recommended to use any form of Blackwood when you have a suit with two quick losers, but NORTH knows SOUTH would not preempt with a 10-high ♥ suit.

SOUTH's reply to RKCB is 5♥, showing two Key Cards. NORTH knows they are the ♥A ♥K so she can count thirteen tricks.

She bids a confident 7NT (and hopes SOUTH didn't open 3♥ with a 6-card suit.

Board 15

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ Q T 8 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ A K 3

♣ A K J

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 6 4 3

♥ A Q 3

♦ Q 7

♣ Q 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♣
Pass	5 ♠		
All Pass			
5 ♠ by North			

[show S] [BID 3!S] [BID 5!C] [BID Pass] [show NS]

NORTH has 21 points, and when she hears SOUTH make a limit raise she tries for slam with RKCB.

SOUTH answers with just one Key Card so NORTH stops at 5 ♠, knowing they are missing two Key Cards.

Of course she didn't expect the two missing Key Cards to be the Ace and King of trumps!

Board 16
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ A Q 9 6
 ♦ 7 6 4
 ♣ K 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 6
 ♥ K 7 5
 ♦ K Q 5 3
 ♣ A J 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			

[show S] [BID 1!D] [BID 2NT] [BID Pass] [show NS] What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, SOUTH showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and NORTH invited him to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K 5

♥ A K 9 7 6 2

♦ K 8

♣ 7 6 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A 9 7 2

♥ Q J 5 3

♦ Q J 7 5 3

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

[show S] [BID 4!C] [BID 6!C] [BID Pass] [show NS] When SOUTH makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, NORTH naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and SOUTH, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what NORTH needed for the 6♥ bid.

Board 18

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K 6 3

♥ K Q T 4

♦ K Q 8 5

♣ 2

♠ Q 9 8 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ A 6 4

♣ K Q J

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

[show S] [BID 1NT] [BID 2!S] [BID 5!S] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When SOUTH announces four ♠s NORTH uses RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in NORTH's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Board 19
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K 6 3

♥ K Q T 4

♦ K Q 8 5

♣ 2

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J 9 8 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ A J 4

♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by South			

[show S] [BID 1NT] [BID 2!S] [BID 5!H] [BID Pass] [show NS] This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, NORTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time SOUTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠ Q.

Now NORTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Board 20
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K 4

♥ J 9 5

♦ A K 7 6

♣ A 5 4

♠ 7 3 2

♥ A K Q 8 6 4

♦ 5 3

♣ 8 7

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
			2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

[show S] [BID 2!H] [BID 3NT] [show NS] The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if NORTH decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when SOUTH shows two Key Cards.

NORTH has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking SOUTH to further describe his hand. SOUTH should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

SOUTH cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so NORTH just passes 3NT.

Board 21

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A Q J 8 6 2

♥ K Q 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A

♠ K 5 3

♥ A 9 5 2

♦ 8 5 4

♣ 6 5 4

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

[show S] [BID 2!D] [BID 3!S] [BID 5!H] [BID Pass]
[show NS] NORTH realizes SOUTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3♠ support bid is enough for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

SOUTH shows two Key Cards and NORTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the red Aces. So she bids 6♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces NORTH might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

Board 22
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 7 2
 ♥ Q 7 4
 ♦ 9 8 5
 ♣ 9 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 5
 ♥ A K 6 5 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ A K Q

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♣	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 2!C] [BID 2!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 5!D] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH's 3 ♥ bid is "encouraging" so SOUTH bids 4NT.

When NORTH shows one Key Card, (an Ace), SOUTH is afraid he may have a trump loser as well the other Ace. To find out about the ♥Q he bids 5 ♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH has the ♥Q but no King so she jumps to 6 ♥.

Board 23

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 7 2

♥ J 9 8 7 4

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A K 6 5 2

♦ 6

♣ A K Q

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 2!C] [BID 2!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 5!D] [BID Pass] [show NS] This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, SOUTH bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH definitely does NOT have the ♥Q. But with five trumps she does know that SOUTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps to 6♥ anyway.

Board 24

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K 9 6 3

♥ A J 7 5

♦ K Q 2

♣ 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5

♥ K Q 9 6 4

♦ 7 3

♣ A K 8 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♠
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 3!C] [BID 4!H] [BID 5!S]
 [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH cannot use RKCB at
 her second bid because trumps have not been agreed.
 So she bids 3♥ to set trumps, knowing SOUTH
 cannot pass after her jump-shift.

SOUTH tries to stop at game but NORTH is too
 strong so she now uses RKCB and gets to 6♥ when
 SOUTH shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.